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Question: What is one of the central concerns of political discourse analysis?

Answer: The central concern is how language represents the world to the public through various linguistic forms.

Question: How is language used in attributing meaning to individuals and groups in political discourse?

Answer: Language is used to attribute meaning to individuals and groups by describing their social practices and actions.

Question: According to cognitive science, what is the nature of mental representation?

Answer: Cognitive science suggests that mental representation is, at least in part, metaphoric in nature.

Question: How do people use metaphor in everyday life, according to cognitive science?

Answer: Metaphor is persistent in everyday life and is used not just in language but in thought and action.

Question: What role do basic-level metaphors play in comprehension, as suggested by cognitive science?

Answer: Basic-level metaphors allow us to comprehend and draw inferences about concepts using our knowledge of familiar domains.

Question: How does cognitive linguistics view metaphors?

Answer: Cognitive linguistics sees metaphors as a mode of representation and thought, not solely a linguistic phenomenon.

Question: Why do we use metaphors when thinking about abstract ideas, as per Lakoff and Johnson?

Answer: We use metaphors to represent abstract ideas because they are difficult to represent directly and are better understood through concrete concepts.

Question: What are some arguments presented in favor of metaphoric representation?

Answer: Metaphoric representation helps us refer to abstract concepts, quantify them, and identify specific aspects, making them more understandable.

Question: Why is the issue of metaphoric representation considered interesting and radical?

Answer: The issue of metaphoric representation is interesting and radical because it challenges traditional views of how language and thought are interconnected.

Question: How has metaphoric representation influenced psychological research?

Answer: Metaphoric representation has influenced psychological research, particularly in theories of idiom and metaphor comprehension.

Question: What are the advantages and disadvantages of discussing metaphoric representation?

Answer: The advantage is gaining insights into how abstract ideas are represented, but the disadvantage is the challenge of defining and discussing verbal metaphors.

Question: How did critical linguistics emerge in the late 1970s?

Answer: Critical linguistics emerged from Halliday's functional linguistic theory, viewing language as a "social fact" displaying politics and ideology through grammatical structure.

Question: What is Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) and how is it related to critical linguistics?

Answer: CDA is a broader analytic program analyzing language to uncover power abuse and inequality in society, and it relates to critical linguistics as a part of this program.

Question: How does Van Dijk define CDA, and what is the aim of this approach?

Answer: Van Dijk defines CDA as a form of critically driven theory and practice aiming to study power abuse and inequality using various methods.

Question: What are some criticisms of the critical approach in CDA?

Answer: The approach has been criticized for potentially confirming preconceived notions and for using linguistic analysis to support claims of power abuse.

Question: Who are some influential scholars in the field of political discourse and CDA?

Answer: Scholars like Norman Fairclough, Ruth Wodak, and Teun van Dijk have been leaders in both political discourse and CDA.

Question: How does the critical analyst view political discourse?

Answer: The critical analyst views political discourse as the use of language and discursive positioning to hide or distribute responsibility and designate specific individuals or groups for political purposes.

Question: What is the relationship between political discourse and phonetics/phonology?

Answer: There has been relatively little attention given to how politicians use phonetic and phonological features of language for political purposes.

Question: How does Margaret Thatcher's speech modification illustrate the impact of phonetics in political persuasion?

Answer: Margaret Thatcher modified her speech to appeal to voters and enhance her political image.

Question: How does the study of prosody in political interviews reveal politicians communication style?

Answer: Politicians tend to reflect a positive and fluid communication style in political interviews.

Question: How have prosodic features been harnessed in political debates to achieve specific effects?

Answer: In political debates, politicians use prosodic features such as pitch, emphasis, and focus to convey assertiveness, irony, emotion, and hyperbole to achieve specific political goals.

Question: How does advertising exemplify the diverse roles of discourse in society?

Answer: Advertising serves as a form of discourse that informs, influences, and relates to different social spheres and activities.

Question: Why does advertising sometimes have a perceived marginal status in discourse analysis?

Answer: Advertising's ability to draw inspiration from various sources and its ultimate commercial aims contribute to its perceived marginality.

Question: What are the primary aims of advertising messages?

Answer: The primary aims of advertising are sales promotion, brand establishment, and reassurance of product quality.

Question: How do advertisements construct social reality?

Answer: Advertisements construct social reality by promoting certain lifestyles, desires, and aspirations while downplaying opposing viewpoints.

Question: What are the three key themes in the study of media in political discourse?

Answer: The three key themes are the ideological nature of media discourse, media representations, and media manipulation.

Question: How does media language reinforce ideology?

Answer: Media language reinforces ideology by presenting certain perspectives as natural, common-sense, or politically correct.

Question: How do politicians use social media to their advantage?

Answer: Politicians use social media to connect directly with their constituents, control their public image, and bypass traditional media gatekeepers.

Question: What is multimodality in political discourse analysis?

Answer: Multimodality refers to the study of how meaning is conveyed through multiple semiotic resources, such as language, images, and gestures, in political discourse.

Question: How does multimodal political discourse analysis contribute to understanding communication strategies?

Answer: Multimodal analysis helps uncover how different modes work together to create meaning and influence political communication strategies.

Question: In what ways do politicians use visuals to enhance their message?

Answer: Politicians use visuals to reinforce their narratives, elicit emotional responses, and establish personal connections with the audience.

Question: How can critical multimodal discourse analysis help unveil power relations?

Answer: Critical multimodal discourse analysis can reveal how power is exercised through the selection and representation of visual and linguistic elements in political communication.

Question: What are the ethical considerations in political discourse analysis research?

Answer: Ethical considerations include ensuring privacy and consent when analyzing personal or sensitive political communications.

Question: What are the limitations of using linguistic devices in political debates?

Answer: Linguistic devices can sometimes be perceived as manipulative or insincere, leading to potential backlash from the public.

Question: How does social identity theory play a role in political discourse?

Answer: Social identity theory explains how individuals categorize themselves into social groups and how these group identities influence political language use and persuasion.

Question: How does social identity affect political discourse?

Answer: Social identity can influence how politicians frame their messages to resonate with specific groups or create divisions between different social categories.

Question: What are some potential challenges faced by political analysts in discourse research?

Answer: Challenges include biases in data collection, ensuring objectivity, and dealing with the dynamic nature of political discourses.

Question: How do metaphors contribute to political discourse analysis?

Answer: Metaphors help shape political narratives and understanding by framing issues in familiar terms that evoke emotional responses from the audience.

Question: What role does context play in political discourse analysis?

Answer: Context is essential in interpreting political discourse, as the same language can have different meanings depending on the situation and participants.

Question: How has the use of multimedia transformed political discourse in recent years?

Answer: The use of multimedia has allowed politicians to reach wider audiences, control their public image, and craft more visually engaging political messages.

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